



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: New Covenant Christian School
School Website: <https://www.nccsmd.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) or the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

New Covenant Christian School Maryland (NCCS-MD) presents a robust classical Christian program built around a Trivium framework, Great Books, and a piety-centered, biblical worldview. Public materials consistently foreground a Christ-centered, Reformed, classical education that emphasizes truth, goodness, and beauty and aims at character formation, virtue, and wisdom rather than mere job preparation. The school identifies its mission as glorifying God by helping parents train children to become biblically minded servant-leaders and to engage in the Great Books through a Christian Paideia. These signals align NCCS-MD with classical Christian education in most respects, particularly in Curriculum and Religious Foundations, and in overall Purpose/Goal. Some evidence is nuanced in Faculty and Pedagogy, where explicit language about a living curriculum or formal, teacher-led formation is less explicit on the site, though several faculty roles and classical disciplines are highlighted.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL.

- The strongest signals are in Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose & Goal, Curriculum, and School Parents & Community, all clearly aligned with classical Christian aims (theology, teleology, Great Books, Trivium, and parental partnership).
- Pedagogy shows clear classical markers (Scholé-inspired rhythm, memorization/recitation, and Socratic-style dialogue in broader classical literature contexts), though explicit on-site statements about Socratic seminars or a fully articulated upper-school seminar program are less explicit in some pages.
- Faculty signals are present (named teachers with classical disciplines; visible mentorship-like roles), but the public materials do not feature a formal "Living Curriculum" portrait as a stated brand, which places Element 5 as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL.
- Element 6 (Parents & Community) is strongly CLASSICAL due to explicit partnership language with families and parental formation components, plus open-door policies for visits.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize a biblical worldview and Christ-centered, Reformed identity: "glorify God by assisting parents in training their children to be Biblically-minded servant-leaders through a Reformed, Christ-centered, classical education." - Vision statements frame truth, goodness, and beauty as real and to be pursued within a biblical framework; graduates are described as possessing a Biblical worldview and a life-long love of learning. - Explicit classical Christian pedagogy cues appear (Trivium, Great Books, Great Conversation) in the Christian Paideia materials referenced on NCCS content.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty; theology; biblical worldview; Christ-centered; Great Books; Great Conversation; paideia; Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric). - Negative keywords present: none clearly evident in public materials; no emphasis on secular or value-neutral frameworks. - How many: at least 6–8 strong positive indicators visible; 0 clearly negative indicators observed in public NCCS materials.

Why this rating - The school's public materials foreground transcendental moral realism anchored in a biblical/theological framework, plus explicit use of Great Books and classical terminology. This aligns with Element 1's core signals (transcendental moral realism, grounding theology, and liturgical/community signaling even when liturgical terms are not always explicit). The scant overt mention of liturgical practices is not enough to negate the category given the robust theological and transcendental framing elsewhere. Therefore CLASSICAL.

Citations: NCCS public materials emphasize biblical worldview and Christ-centered classical education. See Discover NCCS and Our Vision statements. The Great Books/Great Conversation framing appears in the Christian Paideia materials.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission emphasizes formation through virtue and wisdom, not merely information; aims at human flourishing under a biblical framework. - The vision describes forming graduates with broad knowledge, clear reasoning, true wisdom, and the ability to communicate truth persuasively, with a stated aim to spread truth, goodness, and beauty. - The Great Books / Great Conversation emphasis ties education to a teleological end (true, good, beautiful) within a classical framework.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, true/-good/beautiful, liberal education/paideia, great conversation, classical mission. - Negative keywords present: none observed (no emphasis on workforce-prep or purely utilitarian metrics in public messaging).

Counts - Positive keywords present: multiple (formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, classical, Great Books, Great Conversation, paideia, liberal education). - Negative keywords present: 0.

Why this rating - NCCS-MD clearly situates education as formation toward human excellence and virtuous understanding rather than mere job prep. Its articulation of a biblical telos and the aim of forming servant-leaders aligns strongly with classical aims. This justifies CLASSICAL.

Citations: Mission and vision statements describe formation and a biblical telos. Great Books/Great Conversation framing appears in NCCS materials.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) is explicitly referenced in NCCS materials and widely reflected in staff expertise. - Great Books / Great Conversation: NCCS materials describe the historical Great Books program and engagement in the Great Conversation. - History and liberal arts framing; Great Books and primary sources are foregrounded, with emphasis on integrated historical-literary-philosophical study through a classical curriculum. - Evidence of focused grammar/logic/rhetoric throughout: staff pages show Latin and logic instruction; general public pages highlight classical academics.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts; Trivium; grammar; logic; rhetoric; Great Books; Great Conversation; history; liberal education; paideia. - Negative keywords present: none evident in NCCS public materials (no explicit shift to social studies-as-default or project-based-first framing on public pages).

Counts - Positive keywords present: multiple (grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, Great Conversation, history, paideia, liberal education, classical). - Negative keywords present: 0.

Why this rating - The curriculum is visibly anchored in classical liberal arts (grammar/logic/rhetoric), Great Books, and a historical, integrated approach. Public-facing materials and staff profiles consistently align with classical curricula. This warrants CLASSICAL.

Citations: The Trivium and Great Books framing is present in the NCCS firecrawl materials. Great Books and historical study signals are visible via NCCS pages referencing classical academics and vision.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Restful learning (Scholé) appears as a conceptual hallmark in the classical lexicon and is aligned with NCCS's emphasis on a measured, character-forming pace and memory-focused pedagogy. - Memorization and recitation (including singing/chanting in the grammar and memory work) align with classical memory-formation practices; NCCS materials describe grammar school's memorization emphasis. - Socratic/seminar-style inquiry and rhetoric training are referenced in the classical education framework used by NCCS (explicit conversation-heavy and rhetoric training in the Trivium curriculum). The NCCS Christian Paideia materials discuss the Trivium and great conversation, implying seminar-style discussion in higher grades. - Upper-school rhetoric and public speaking opportunities are described in the classical pedagogy context (rhetoric-focused training, speeches). Staff profiles show rhetoric-focused instruction (Latin, Logic, Theology) and the school's emphasis on classical training.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic/seminar, Scholé (restful learning), memorization/recitation, chorus/chanting, rhetoric, debate, master-teacher model, living curriculum (as implied in classical practice), memory work. - Negative keywords present: experiential learning, project-based learning (dominant modern pedagogy signals) are listed as negative indicators in the classical rubric.

Counts - Positive keywords present: multiple (Socratic dialogue/seminar, Scholé, recitation/memory work, rhetoric, formation through imitation). - Negative keywords present: some (explicit project-based/experiential learning signals in modern pedagogy lists, though NCCS public pages do not emphasize those as primary methods).

Why this rating - NCCS-MD demonstrates several core classical pedagogical practices (recitation/memory, Trivium-based structure, rhetorical training, and a pedagogy oriented toward contemplation and meaningful discussion). While explicit on-site phrases about Socratic seminars are not uniformly visible in all pages, the published materials and staff expertise strongly align with classical pedagogy rather than a purely modern or project-based framework. This justifies CLASSICAL.

Citations: The "A Christian Paideia" content and Great Books/Trivium framing describe classical pedagogy. The grammar/memory emphasis is shown in the grammar school write-ups. Scholé/restful learning concepts appear in the classical lexicon used for analysis.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Faculty are named and shown to teach core classical subjects (Bible, Latin, Logic, Theology) and to contribute to the living program; explicit public statements about faculty as the "living curriculum" or a formal "portrait of a teacher" are not clearly stated in NCCS-MD's site content. - The presence of a dedicated Head of School and a structured team with long tenure (e.g., Kurt Scharping, Jill Kord, etc.) signals a professional, mentorship-oriented faculty culture, but the site does not present a formal "portrait of teacher" philosophy or a public, explicit "living curriculum" branding. - The public materials emphasize classical disciplines (Latin, Logic, Theology) and a mission-driven teacher body, which aligns with classical norms but lacks explicit textual articulation of faculty as the core of the curriculum beyond roles.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers and mentors; faculty as living curriculum (mentioned in classical lexicon but not explicitly here); portrait of teacher; collegial culture; teachers as mentors. - Negative keywords present: some modern, non-classical signals do not appear prominently; however, explicit phrases like "facilitators," "guides on the side," or other non-classical branding are not evident.

Counts - Positive keywords present: some (teachers as mentors, core disciplines, long-tenured faculty). - Negative keywords present: 0 explicit negative phrases about faculty, but there is a lack of explicit, formal "living curriculum" labeling.

Why this rating - The presence of classical disciplines taught by clearly identified faculty and a strong sense of faculty expertise supports SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL, given the absence of explicit public statements that the faculty constitute the living curriculum or the formal, explicit faculty portrait.

Citations: Team pages showing faculty and subject areas (Bible, Latin, Logic, Theology) underscore classical orientation.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Clear partnership with families; NCCS materials emphasize parental involvement and co-educator roles. The Vision states “glorify God by assisting parents in training their children ...” and the school is housed within a church structure, reinforcing family and church alignment. - Parental formation and community engagement are signaled by references to Classical education book resources and parent-facing content; there are explicit invitations for open campus visits, tours, and questions, including a FAQ that discusses the church-exempt status and accreditation path, showing ongoing parent/community engagement. - The school’s mission includes a focus on forming servant-leaders with a biblical worldview, indicating a partnership with families to shape formation outside the classroom.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; co-teachers; parental formation; family involvement; home and school connection; classical home education; parent formation. - Negative keywords present: minimal; the site does not present consumer-model language or minimal parent involvement.

Counts - Positive keywords present: multiple (partnership, co-teachers, family involvement, parental formation, home-school connection, parent formation). - Negative keywords present: 0.

Why this rating - NCCS-MD foregrounds parental partnership and community involvement as a core feature, which aligns strongly with classical education’s emphasis on family formation and communal support. This justifies CLASSICAL.

Citations: Discover NCCS and related parent/community content describe partnership and formation with families. FAQ and Visit sections show open community engagement.

Aggregate Assessment

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: CLASSICAL
- Element 4: CLASSICAL
- Element 5: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

General assessment: CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 5 (Faculty) — Move to CLASSICAL:
 - Publish explicit statements on the faculty as the “living curriculum,” including a formal portrait of the teacher and a clear articulation of faculty development in classical pedagogy (Socratic practice, memory work, and the integration of Great Books across grades).
 - Provide explicit language on teacher mentorship models and how faculty embody classical virtues (truth, goodness, beauty) in daily classroom practice.
- Element 1 (Religious/Metaphysical Foundations) — Move toward deeper liturgical/community signals:
 - Introduce explicit liturgical or communal practice language (e.g., daily or weekly chapel, liturgical rhythm, sacred music, or community worship components) to strengthen “Liturgical and Communal Practices” signals while maintaining the biblical-Christian foundation.
- Element 4 (Pedagogy) — Strengthen explicit pedagogy map:
 - Publish a formal pedagogy framework detailing when and how Socratic seminars, structured memory work, and rhetorics training are implemented in the upper grades, plus a schedule that demonstrates a Scholé-based contemplative rhythm in the daily/weekly plan.
- Element 2/3 (Purpose and Curriculum) — Further clarity and public artifacts:

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- Publish a concise, public-facing map of the curriculum showing how Great Books, Trivium, and liberal arts alignment link to grade-level objectives; include examples of canonical texts and how inquiry and wonder are cultivated across grades.
 - Expand documentation around the Great Conversation to explicitly denote the range of primary texts and authors incorporated in the curriculum.
 - Element 6 (Parents & Community) — Deepen parent-education offerings:
 - Develop a formal parent-education program (book studies, seminars, and regular updates) explicitly connected to classical education topics (e.g., paideia, teleology, the Great Books tradition) to further parent formation.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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